

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Significance of Sociology, Social Structure of Bangladesh

Lecture 4.2

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Key Terms of Sociology

- **Social Stratification** – an institutionalized pattern of inequality in which social statuses are ranked on the basis of their access to scarce resources.
- **Caste** – rely largely on ascribed statuses as the basis for distributing scarce resources.
- **Class** – in Marxist theory, class refers to a person's relationship to the means of production. Class systems rely largely on achieved statuses as the basis for distributing scarce resources.
- **Socioeconomic Status** – measure of social class that ranks individuals on income, education, occupation, or some combination of these.
- **Sex** – a biological characteristic, male or female.
- **Gender** – the expected dispositions and behaviors that cultures assign to each sex.

Significance of Sociology (1/2)

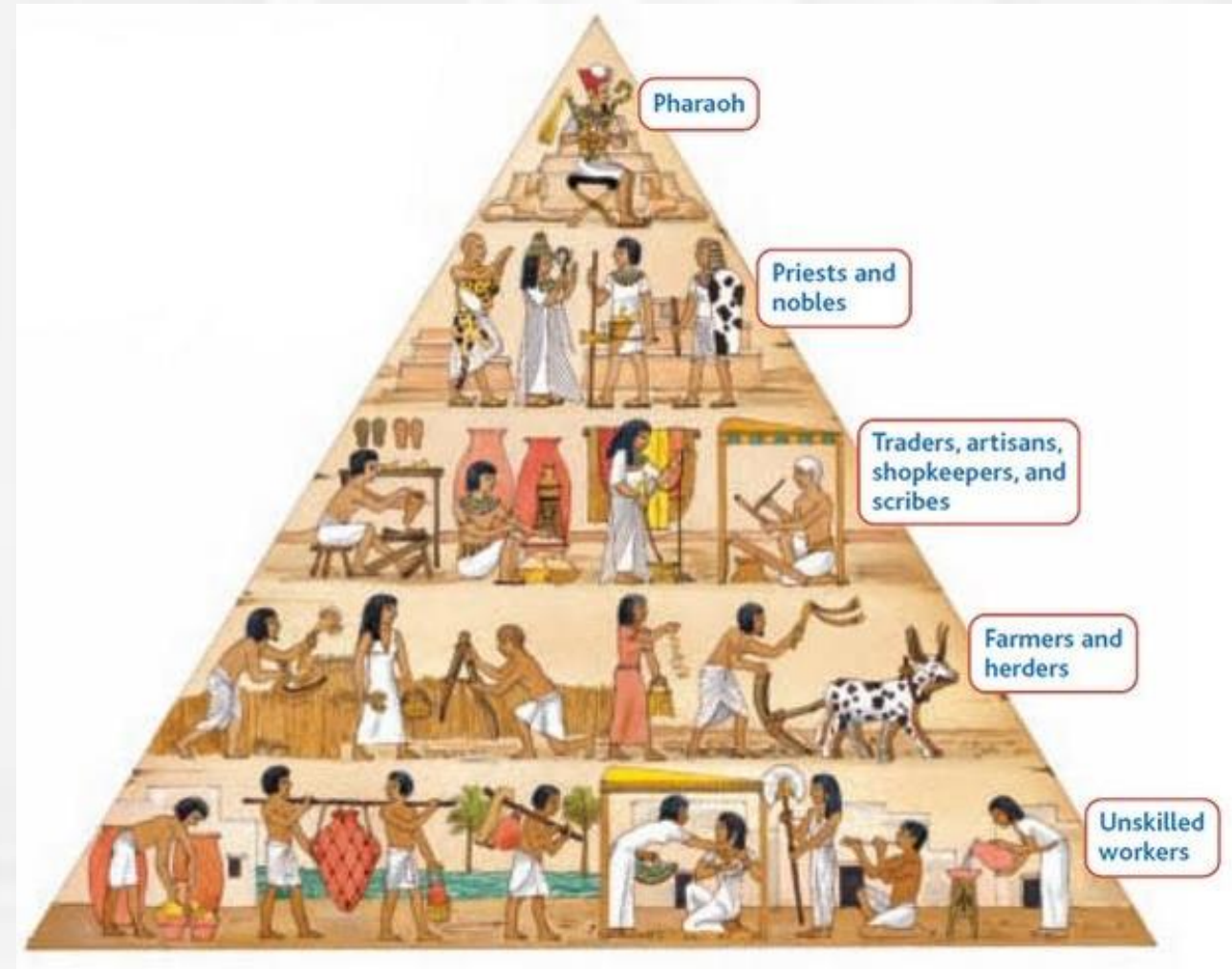
- Can help identify social needs.
- Provide him the opportunity to investigate, analyze and understand social problems and social institutions, and existing social norms and values.
- In every society, there are some complex problems which if not immediately solved, can create many more serious problems. The study of Sociology can help us in locating such problems and finding out the magnitude of the problem and seek help in solving these.
- Sociology has helped governments promote welfare to the tribal people as well.
- Through Sociology, people have knowledge about the multi-ethnic, multi-cultural, multi-lingual, and multi-religious society where we live in and also provides us with knowledge about unity in diversity that promotes national solidarity.

Significance of Sociology (2/2)

- The knowledge about cultural heritage and its significance not only inculcate in us the sense of pride but also instill in us the measures and needs of their conservation.
- Sociological knowledge has changed our perspectives towards our fellow human beings and also on the wrongdoers (such as criminals) in our society.
- Sociology in one way promotes the responsibility of a person as a member of society and in another way promotes harmony and unity, therefore helping in the reduction of social frictions and tensions.
- Sociology that helps in identifying gaps existing between theory and practice in tackling social, economic, and other problems.
- It helps to find the new social problems that society is likely to face.

Social Structure

- **Social structure** is the term that is given to all of the interconnected relationships of the various social groups and institutions in which people create and become part of.
- These groups include but are not limited to: families, schools, religious organizations, social clubs, etc.



Elements of Social Structure

Social structure can be broken down into differing elements: status, roles, social networks, groups, and organizations.

- **Status** is an indicator of subjective ranking throughout society or within a social group. Such indicators might include wealth, titles, or even something as simple as what clothes they wear.
- **Roles** have to do with what an individual does and the acts he is expected to perform. For instance, someone's role in society is to clean up garbage off of public streets. He may be looked down upon and seen as lower than others.
- **Social networks** are the different types of social groups people tether themselves to and how those groups interact and are viewed in society.
- **Groups and organizations** provide the opportunity for much broader social structure and connections to be made.